

be incorporated through simple click-and-draw or drag-and-drop functions.

The panel on the right shows the list of layers being worked on. It also displays the list of blocks being used in the project. Users can choose to keep layers and blocks visible or invisible from this panel. On the top, there are generic menus like File, Edit, View and Select, as well as some operation-specific options like Layer, Block, Dimension, Modify, Snap, Info.

Below the menu bar, there are some buttons for different zoom properties and layer-wise zooming, adding layers, copying layers, moving layers and so on. Users can also access Save and Print options from this panel. They can change the layers from dropdowns below.

At the bottom, command line panel displays commands, outputs and messages for your project.

Tools let you change colour and size of the work area, and also customise the elements. Grid-view and guides help to keep design in the desired scale. 'Explode text into letters' feature allows insertion of text annotations into the drawing.

Using LibreCAD effectively

The palette and the list of retouching tools

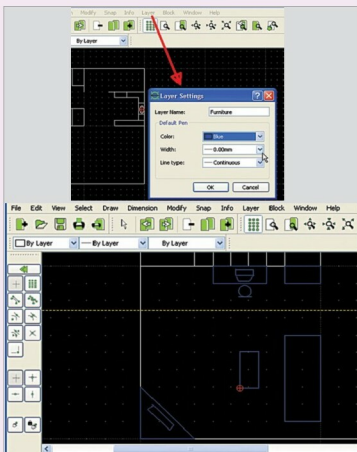


Fig. 3: Setting up a layer in LibreCAD (Source: makeuseof.com)

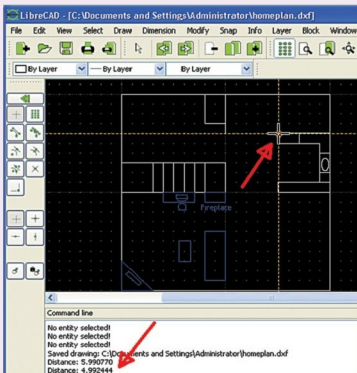


Fig. 4: Measurements in LibreCAD (Source: makeuseof.com)

in LibreCAD is quite extensive. Other than building from scratch, this CAD software can also edit external files. It supports DXF and CXF file formats for opening. The tool also saves its files in the same formats. Users can export the developed projects as image files in jpg, png, tif, bmp, ppm, xpm and xbm formats.

As mentioned earlier, quick-access buttons eliminate the need to run around the maze of options to find your function. Tooltips make it even simpler. In case you are not familiar with a button or symbol, tooltips precisely tells its function.

Aligning straight lines or blocks in the drawing is easy with LibreCAD. You can use snap-to-grid feature while drawing, which ensures all straight lines or shapes are placed along grids in the workspace. Plus, you can use the measurement tool (looks like '+' symbol) to make all the dimensions accurate and maintain perfect spacing between elements as desired. Results are displayed in the output panel at the bottom.

The layering feature also helps users arrange and assign elements in a more organised and easily identifiable fashion. Users can selectively view or hide layers as required.